

Pigeon Patrol — one business, five levels

The task: students plan, run and evaluate a small business for the school. Every worked example below describes the **same** student business — Pigeon Patrol, a service that clears pigeons from school eating areas — written five times, once at each level of the continuum.

Read across to see what changes between one level and the next. **Read down** to go from the worked example, to the reason it meets that level, to the exact continuum descriptor. Only the phrases that **prove** a criterion are marked — the black text is the glue that holds them together.

■ Business success Why the business exists, what makes it work, and how it stays ahead of competitors. <u>marked like this</u> ▲ Innovation & entrepreneurship Taking the initiative, testing ideas, and improving something that already exists. <u>marked like this</u> ● Business decisions Costs, benefits, risks, and the effects a decision has — intended and unintended. <u>marked like this</u> ◆ Metacognition Naming your own contribution, then checking, adjusting and justifying your strategy. <u>marked like this</u>					
LEVEL	Level 6 STATES AND IDENTIFIES	Level 7 EXPECTED · YEAR 7	Level 8 EXPLAINS EFFECTS	Level 9 EVALUATES TRADE-OFFS	Level 10 JUSTIFIES WITH ANALYSIS
WORKED EXAMPLE Pigeon Patrol, written at this level	We started Pigeon Patrol so we could <u>remove pigeons safely from eating areas</u> and students could use the space. We tried <u>fake hawk kites and scent gel</u> because we didn’t want to harm the birds. We chose <u>cheap netting instead of metal spikes so the school could afford it</u> . After asking teachers and students what changed, <u>I wrote down what we would adjust next time.</u>	We noticed pigeons were ruining lunch spots, so we offered a service the school could <u>book and pay for</u> . We tested <u>hawk kites, scent gel, and frisbees</u> ; frisbees were <u>\$0</u> but someone had to keep throwing them, while gel cost <u>\$15</u> but worked all day. We considered rocks (also free) but rejected it because <u>one broken window could cost hundreds. I handled the customer survey and noted what worked.</u>	We ran two one-week trials and recorded results, then <u>changed our plan based on what the data showed (gel near bins + netting at the worst corner)</u> . The result was <u>fewer lunchtime complaints and a cleaner area</u> , but gel near bins needed signage so students didn’t touch it. We identified <u>risks like injury or property damage and reduced them with clear rules. Next time I would collect data for longer and write clearer instructions for helpers.</u>	Other pest-control businesses could offer the same service, so we offered a <u>“no-poo guarantee” and faster response packages</u> . We knew another school was already using scent gel and netting, so we copied that and used <u>gel near bins plus netting in the corner pigeons treated like a VIP lounge</u> . At first we assumed a stronger guarantee would win everyone over, but <u>after tracking call-outs we capped the free returns</u> . We weighed benefits (trust, repeat bookings) against costs like <u>free call-outs, staff time, and extra labour</u> . We priced the guarantee higher to cover that labour but noted it might reduce demand from smaller schools.	To maintain our edge, we <u>tracked outcomes across multiple schools each term</u> (how long pigeon numbers stayed low, and how many follow-up visits were needed). <u>We decided our criteria were effectiveness over time, staff workload, and cost per school per term</u> . We used a simple <u>cost–benefit analysis</u> : better equipment cost <u>\$600</u> upfront, but reduced repeat visits by <u>2 per school per term</u> . If a repeat visit costs <u>\$80</u> , that’s <u>\$160 saved per school per term</u> . When those savings didn’t show up at smaller schools, <u>we adjusted the service instead of buying more gear</u> . We kept improving it with <u>new signage, better scheduling, and improved packages</u> so customers stayed happy.
WHY IT MEETS THIS LEVEL What each marked phrase proves	■ Business success: states the purpose and identifies this as a service (not a good). ▲ Innovation: a trial is present, but it is not explained as a process. ● Business decisions: includes one decision with an effect (affordability → netting choice). ◆ Metacognition: feedback is collected, but the personal contribution is not specified.	■ Business success: uses a real problem + willingness to pay. ▲ Entrepreneurship: shows initiative and risk (pitching / organising). ● Business decisions: describes costs and benefits with concrete comparisons (\$0 vs \$15; window damage). ◆ Metacognition: explicitly identifies the personal contribution. NOT YET: Discusses costs and benefits, but does not yet show systematic testing over time or broader consequences.	■ Business success: links actions to outcomes (complaints / cleanliness). ▲ Entrepreneur contribution: shows the service being improved on the basis of evidence. ● Business decisions: explains costs and benefits including the effects and potential consequences (signage, rules, risks). ◆ Metacognition: reflects and names a specific improvement. NOT YET: Explains consequences, but does not yet evaluate market competition or strategic trade-offs.	■ Competitive advantage: describes why differentiation matters in a competitive market. ▲ Innovation: explains innovation as iterative improvement and combination, not invention. ● Business decisions: evaluates intended benefits against unintended effects (free call-outs, time, demand). ◆ Metacognition: shows strategies being selected, monitored and adjusted — the assumption is revised after tracking call-outs. NOT YET: Evaluates consequences, but does not yet justify with a full numerical cost-benefit calculation across contexts.	■ Maintaining advantage: uses longitudinal tracking across schools. ▲ Innovation in the real world: connects ongoing improvement to how service businesses succeed beyond school scenarios. ● Cost-benefit analysis: justifies an investment with numbers and payback logic. ◆ Metacognition: develops and refines criteria for viability and sustainability, and adapts the plan when the evidence changes by context.
LEARNING CONTINUUM	LEVEL 6	LEVEL 7	LEVEL 8	LEVEL 9	LEVEL 10
BUSINESS SUCCESS	I can explain the purpose of a business and recognise the different ways that businesses choose to provide goods and services.	I can outline the characteristics of successful businesses.	I can describe the characteristics of successful businesses and the way these businesses use enterprising behaviours.	I can describe why businesses need to create competitive advantage.	I can explain how a business could maintain a competitive advantage.
INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP	<i>Not on the continuum until Level 7.</i>	I can outline the characteristics of an entrepreneur.	I can explain how entrepreneurs contribute to business success.	I can explain the nature of innovation.	I can discuss how innovation has contributed to business success in the real world.
BUSINESS DECISIONS	I can identify the possible effects of business decisions.	I can describe the costs and benefits of different business decisions.	I can explain the costs and benefits of different business decisions, including the effects and potential consequences of these actions.	I can evaluate the costs and benefits of different business decisions, including the intended and unintended effects and potential consequences of these actions.	I can use cost-benefit analysis to justify business decisions.
METACOGNITION	I can identify how I contributed to the group task.	I can reflect on my participation in the group task.	I can reflect on my participation in the group task and describe areas for improvement.	I can explain how I selected, monitored and adjusted strategies during the task, and how evidence changed my thinking.	I can explain how I developed and refined criteria to judge whether decisions were viable and sustainable over time.

Levels 6–10 use the Victorian Curriculum Economics and Business continuum wording, plus the Critical and Creative Thinking (metacognition) strand. **Level 7 is the expected level for Year 7** and is boxed in gold. Each criterion carries two signals — a colour *and* an underline pattern — so the wall still works photocopied in black and white. Marked with ■ ▲ ● ◆ in the explanation band for the same reason.